



Sigurd and Brynhildr

Soon after his fight with the dragon, Sigurd went on a journey into the mountains and came upon a grand hall. Inside lay a woman wearing golden armour, which seemed to grow from her skin.

“Who’s this?” Sigurd wondered. He removed the armour and found inside a beautiful warrior-woman called Brynhildr. The woman saw Sigurd’s goodness, and he recognized her strength. They agreed to marry.

First, Sigurd had another matter to attend to. A sorceress had wanted Sigurd to marry her daughter, Gudrun. So Sigurd travelled to their court to explain about his new-found love.

The sorceress was not happy. She fed Sigurd a potion that made him forget his love for Brynhildr and agree to marry Gudrun instead. On top of this, the scheming sorceress offered her son, Gunnar, to Brynhildr as a husband. But Brynhildr didn’t want to marry this man. She said she would only marry Gunnar if he passed through the wall of flames that surrounded her hall.